

Tricky capitalized words

Certain words sometimes begin with a capital letter and other times they don't. It's important to know when to use a capital letter, so that written sentences make sense.

In some cases, capital letters are the only distinguishing factor between two words that are spelled the same way, but mean very different things.

Confused words	Lowercase meaning	Capitalized meaning
alpine and Alpine	relating to mountainous areas	relating to the Alps
august and August	majestic	the eighth month of the year
cancer and Cancer	a disease	a constellation and astrological sign
china and China	porcelain	a country in eastern Asia
earth and Earth	soil, dry land	the planet we live on
jack and Jack	a device for lifting heavy items	a male name
italic and Italic	a sloping typeface	relating to Italy
lent and Lent	the past tense of the verb <i>lend</i>	in Christianity, the period preceding Easter
march and March	to walk briskly and rhythmically	the third month of the year
marine and Marine	relating to the ocean	a member of the Marine Corps
mercury and Mercury	a chemical element	the closest planet to the Sun
nice and Nice	pleasant	a city in the south of France
pole and Pole	a long cylindrical object	a person from Poland
turkey and Turkey	a bird	a country in the Middle East

Common Latin and Greek roots

Latin root	Meaning	Examples
act	do	action , enact
ang	bend	angle , triangle
cap	head	capital , decapitate
dic	speak	dictate , predict
imag	likeness	image , imagination
just	law	justice , justify
ques	ask, seek	question , request
sci	know	conscience , science

Greek root	Meaning	Examples
arch	chief	archbishop , monarch
auto	self	autobiography , automatic
cosm	universe	cosmopolitan , cosmos
gen	birth, race	generation , genocide
log	word	apology , dialogue
lys	break down	analysis , catalyst
morph	shape	metamorphosis , morphology
phon	sound	symphony , telephone